

Classwork 07//KL Divergence in DDPM

Student Name: _____ **Points:** 30

A Number: _____ **Due Date:** March 23, 2026

KL Divergence for Denoising Diffusion Model (DDPM) is given by

$$KL(q, p) = \underbrace{\mathbb{E}_{q(\mathbf{x}_0, \mathbf{x}_1, \dots, \mathbf{x}_T)} \left[-\log p(\mathbf{x}_T) - \sum_{t=1}^T \log \frac{p_\theta(\mathbf{x}_{t-1} | \mathbf{x}_t)}{q(\mathbf{x}_t | \mathbf{x}_{t-1})} \right]}_{=L} + \text{constant}$$

Show that L can be written as

$$\mathbb{E}_{q(\mathbf{x}_0, \mathbf{x}_1, \dots, \mathbf{x}_T)} \left[KL(q(\mathbf{x}_T | \mathbf{x}_0) || p(\mathbf{x}_T)) + \sum_{t>1} KL(q(\mathbf{x}_{t-1} | \mathbf{x}_t, \mathbf{x}_0) || p_\theta(\mathbf{x}_{t-1} | \mathbf{x}_t)) - \log p_\theta(\mathbf{x}_0 | \mathbf{x}_1) \right]$$

Use the fundamental definition of KL divergence for proving.

Proof:

The logarithm identity can be used for proving. First, we note that $\log \frac{a}{b} = \log a - \log b$. Use $\mathbf{x}_0, \mathbf{x}_1, \dots, \mathbf{x}_T = \mathbf{x}_0 : \mathbf{x}_T$ notation.

We also note that $KL(q, p) = \mathbb{E}_q[\log \frac{q}{p}]$.

Then,

$$\begin{aligned} L &= \mathbb{E}_{q(\mathbf{x}_0 : \mathbf{x}_T)} \left[-\log p(\mathbf{x}_T) - \sum_{t=1}^T \log \frac{p_\theta(\mathbf{x}_{t-1} | \mathbf{x}_t)}{q(\mathbf{x}_t | \mathbf{x}_{t-1})} \right] \\ &= \mathbb{E}_{q(\mathbf{x}_0 : \mathbf{x}_T)} \left[-\log p(\mathbf{x}_T) - \sum_{t=1}^T \log p_\theta(\mathbf{x}_{t-1} | \mathbf{x}_t) + \sum_{t=1}^T \log q(\mathbf{x}_t | \mathbf{x}_{t-1}) \right] \end{aligned}$$

Also, we know from Bayes' theorem that

$$q(\mathbf{x}_t | \mathbf{x}_{t-1}) = \frac{q(\mathbf{x}_{t-1} | \mathbf{x}_t, \mathbf{x}_0) q(\mathbf{x}_t | \mathbf{x}_0)}{q(\mathbf{x}_{t-1} | \mathbf{x}_0)}$$

Thus,

$$\sum_{t=1}^T \log q(\mathbf{x}_t | \mathbf{x}_{t-1}) = \log q(\mathbf{x}_1 | \mathbf{x}_0) + \sum_{t=2}^T \left[\log q(\mathbf{x}_{t-1} | \mathbf{x}_t, \mathbf{x}_0) + \log q(\mathbf{x}_t | \mathbf{x}_0) - \log q(\mathbf{x}_{t-1} | \mathbf{x}_0) \right]$$

If we expand the sum, then consecutive $\log q(\mathbf{x}_t | \mathbf{x}_0)$ with $+$ and $-$ will cancel out.

Hence,

$$\sum_{t=1}^T \log q(\mathbf{x}_t | \mathbf{x}_{t-1}) = \sum_{t=2}^T \log q(\mathbf{x}_{t-1} | \mathbf{x}_t, \mathbf{x}_0) + \log q(\mathbf{x}_T | \mathbf{x}_0)$$

Then

$$L = \mathbb{E}_q(\mathbf{x}_0 : \mathbf{x}_T) \left[-\log p(\mathbf{x}_T) + \sum_{t=2}^T \log q(\mathbf{x}_{t-1} | \mathbf{x}_t, \mathbf{x}_0) + \log q(\mathbf{x}_T | \mathbf{x}_0) - \sum_{t=1}^T \log p_\theta(\mathbf{x}_{t-1} | \mathbf{x}_t) \right]$$

Split the sum over p_θ , we have

$$-\sum_{t=1}^T \log p_\theta(\mathbf{x}_{t-1} | \mathbf{x}_t) = -\log p_\theta(\mathbf{x}_0 | \mathbf{x}_1) - \sum_{t=2}^T \log p_\theta(\mathbf{x}_{t-1} | \mathbf{x}_t)$$

Thus

$$\begin{aligned} L &= \mathbb{E}_q(\mathbf{x}_0 : \mathbf{x}_T) \left[-\log p(\mathbf{x}_T) + \sum_{t=2}^T \log q(\mathbf{x}_{t-1} | \mathbf{x}_t, \mathbf{x}_0) + \log q(\mathbf{x}_T | \mathbf{x}_0) \right. \\ &\quad \left. - \log p_\theta(\mathbf{x}_0 | \mathbf{x}_1) - \sum_{t=2}^T \log p_\theta(\mathbf{x}_{t-1} | \mathbf{x}_t) \right] \\ L &= \mathbb{E}_q(\mathbf{x}_0 : \mathbf{x}_T) \left[\frac{\log q(\mathbf{x}_T | \mathbf{x}_0)}{\log p(\mathbf{x}_T)} + \sum_{t=2}^T \log \frac{q(\mathbf{x}_{t-1} | \mathbf{x}_t, \mathbf{x}_0)}{p_\theta(\mathbf{x}_{t-1} | \mathbf{x}_t)} - \log p_\theta(\mathbf{x}_0 | \mathbf{x}_1) \right] \end{aligned}$$

Each log is argument to KL as per its definition, thus, taking expectations over $q(\mathbf{x}_0 : \mathbf{x}_T)$

$$L = \mathbb{E}_q(\mathbf{x}_0 : \mathbf{x}_T) \left[KL(q(\mathbf{x}_T | \mathbf{x}_0) || p(\mathbf{x}_T)) + \sum_{t=2}^T KL(q(\mathbf{x}_{t-1} | \mathbf{x}_t, \mathbf{x}_0) || p_\theta(\mathbf{x}_{t-1} | \mathbf{x}_t)) - \log p_\theta(\mathbf{x}_0 | \mathbf{x}_1) \right]$$